

I found a strong cluster of Heptabase material around **one core design desire**: a native-feeling, Apple-integrated, low-friction personal system that reduces app fragmentation, preserves context across tools, supports quick capture and retrieval, and uses AI/automation without forcing everything into one brittle mega-app. [\[1\]\[2\]\[3\]\[4\]](#)

High-level synthesis

- The dominant frustration is **workflow fragmentation**: notes, tasks, files, links, reading queues, and plans are scattered across multiple tools, creating decision fatigue and making it unclear where information belongs or what the next action is. [\[5\]\[6\]\[7\]](#)
- The strongest “dream-system” theme is **modularity with interoperability**: data storage, manipulation, and presentation should be separable, so the user can choose the best tool for each layer without losing context or control. [\[3\]\[2\]\[1\]](#)
- The Apple ecosystem is attractive because it already gestures toward **structured entities, permissions, Shortcuts, deep links, App Intents, and HealthKit-style interoperability**, but Ven repeatedly notes that the model is incomplete and inconsistent across Notes, Reminders, Finder, Mail, Calendar, Photos, Safari, and Freeform. [\[8\]\[9\]\[10\]\[11\]](#)
- The most cool-relevant AI idea is an assistant that can **look across a day of activity**—videos watched, books/pages read, sites browsed, notes made, and app activity—and produce a meaningful overview, ideally while respecting native apps and privacy. [\[4\]\[12\]](#)
- For research workflows, the recurring need is a unified system for **collecting, reading, tracking, annotating, linking, and retrieving academic content**, especially around Zotero, PDFs, reading queues, metadata, annotations, citations, and references. [\[13\]\[14\]\[15\]\[16\]](#)

Dream-system / personal assistant ideas

- **Source** — Journal 2025-10-05
Date — 2025-10-05
Why-relevant tag — daily AI overview / dream-system spec
Excerpt — “Would love to be able to create an automation using AI to look

through my activity of a day x the videos I've watched, the books and pages I've read, the sites I've browsed, the notes I've made and so on, and to give me an overview of what I was doing." Ven notes that Notes, Reminders, Book Tracker, and Safari are easier to query through Shortcuts, while Heptabase, YouTube, Readwise Reader, Wikipedia, and Kindle are harder because he prefers native apps and cannot query them directly through Shortcuts. [\[4\]](#)

Cross-references — "Write a short summary of each day" and "By embedding links to whiteboards in my daily note" both point toward daily-life/activity reconstruction as a product direction. [\[12\]](#)[\[17\]](#)

- **Source — Write a short summary of each day. Organize daily notes in a board in the form of a timeline**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — daily memory / personal timeline

Excerpt — Ven wants short daily summaries at the top of the daily journal so he can look back and quickly see what days, weeks, or months were like, including what he did, who he met, what he watched/read/listened to, how he felt, focus level, sleep, and exercise. He also asks how he would find all days where he climbed or met a friend, and how to keep track of notes created or worked on in the daily note. [\[12\]](#)

Cross-references — This pairs directly with the AI daily-activity overview idea in Journal 2025-10-05. [\[4\]](#)

- **Source — Journal 2024-07-20**

Date — 2024-07-20

Why-relevant tag — AI across all content / monkey-brain capture

Excerpt — Ven describes "monkey brain" and random thoughts while struggling with file/project restructuring, then asks whether there is "an AI app that takes in info from all my content." [\[18\]](#)

Cross-references — This links conceptually to the later desire for AI to review the whole day's activity. [\[4\]](#)

- **Source — A good UI is more than decoration. By reducing friction and busy work, it helps you stay in the flow of thinking**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — mind-reader UI principle

Excerpt — Ven writes that he does not want to spend more time than necessary interacting with software, and that great software is "almost like a mind-reader": when a desire commonly occurs in a specific context, the

software should make it as easy as possible to achieve. [\[19\]](#)

Cross-references — This is a compact design principle for coo4one: context-aware suggestions should remove busywork without adding interface burden. [\[19\]](#)

- **Source — Modular software design - discussion with RaycastAI**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — entity graph / assistant architecture

Excerpt — Ven explores a system where entities have unique identifiers, relationships are tracked in a system-level graph, apps can query those relationships, and links become first-class citizens. The proposed model would support relationship queries, context awareness, automated suggestions, change propagation, and dynamic relationship discovery. [\[20\]](#)
[\[21\]](#)

Cross-references — Hookmark appears as a rough prototype of the “overlay” or relationship-layer idea, but Ven also identifies its limits because linked entities are not themselves relationship-aware. [\[22\]](#)[\[23\]](#)

Frustrations with current tools / anti-features

- **Source — Journal 2024-09-04**

Date — 2024-09-04

Why-relevant tag — app overload / decision fatigue

Excerpt — Ven says he needs to drastically reduce the number of tools he uses because notes, tasks, links, and plans are scattered everywhere, leaving him with no clear idea where to put things, where things already are, or what the next actionable item is. He describes this as information overwhelm, decision fatigue, and being lost in “the labyrinthian halls” of his digital space. [\[5\]](#)

Cross-references — Journal 2024-09-06 continues this with an explicit app detox and commitment to consolidate into Heptabase. [\[24\]](#)

- **Source — Journal 2024-09-06**

Date — 2024-09-06

Why-relevant tag — app detox / consolidation

Excerpt — Ven writes that he needs fewer note-taking and organization apps to reduce confusion and decision fatigue, and that although Heptabase does not have everything he wants, it has enough to stop shopping around and consolidate other notes into it. His app detox tasks include importing daily notes, making Heptabase boards for daily notes and

imported cards, deciding a project structure, and deciding the role of Apple Notes. [\[24\]](#)

Cross-references — This directly follows the “digital mess” described on 2024-09-04. [\[5\]](#)

- **Source — Journal 2024-07-20**

Date — 2024-07-20

Why-relevant tag — **scattered information / infinite canvas concern**

Excerpt — Ven says testing several apps causes information to be split across tools, makes it unclear where information might be, and prevents a consistent workflow. He also notices a potential problem with infinite canvases as organization tools: it can be hard to stay aware of what else is available on the board. [\[6\]](#)

Cross-references — The “Learning Heptabase” board later contains both praise for spatial organization and notes about how to make Heptabase workflows usable. [\[25\]](#)[\[26\]](#)

- **Source — Journal 2025-05-16**

Date — 2025-05-16

Why-relevant tag — **Heptabase iPad frustration**

Excerpt — Ven wishes he had full Heptabase functionality on iPad because he loves the device’s lightweight portable experience, but many tools are much better on desktop OS. [\[27\]](#)

Cross-references — Journal 2025-10-05 adds that Heptabase in Safari on iPad has improved somewhat, but React/JavaScript web apps still perform poorly on iPad. [\[4\]](#)

- **Source — Restructure file and note management**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — **Heptabase limitations / anti-features**

Excerpt — The whiteboard lists Heptabase limitations such as only having one window, no bidirectional links in properties, no automations/API/Raycast integration, no quick capture, and no custom properties for notes.

Cross-references — These limitations map directly onto coo4one requirements around multi-window work, system integration, quick capture, automation, and structured metadata.

- **Source — Thoughts on Readwise reader experience on iPad**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — **iPad-native UX expectations**

Excerpt — Ven wants iPad apps with large-screen affordances, persistent sidebars, and keyboard interactions that feel close to desktop when a keyboard is attached. He criticizes Reader's iPad app for overlay sidebars, lack of keyboard shortcuts, inconsistent trackpad behavior, and broken PDF loading. [\[33\]](#)[\[34\]](#)

Cross-references — This reinforces that coo4one should not be “mobile-shaped” on iPad; it should respect iPad as a serious keyboard/trackpad workspace. [\[33\]](#)[\[34\]](#)

Modularity, interoperability, and Apple-system philosophy

- **Source** — The Case for Modularity: Why Modern Software Feels Broken

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — modular software manifesto

Excerpt — Ven describes exhaustion from fighting tools: task managers do not talk to notes, files are locked in cloud ecosystems, and apps operate in isolation. He frames modern software fragmentation as a barrier to thinking, creating, and organizing, and argues for modularity, interoperability, user control, and true collaboration between tools. [\[1\]](#)[\[35\]](#)

Cross-references — This is the polished companion to the more detailed “Modular software design” discussion. [\[3\]](#)[\[36\]](#)

- **Source** — We need more modular software

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — modular PKM / anti-mega-app

Excerpt — Ven says many productivity apps bundle data, control/query/modification/organization, and display into one package, even though those functions could be better handled by specialized modules. He wants modular software where notes, canvas boards, command palettes, tagging systems, emails, tasks, documents, and other content types can connect without manually recreating a project in every app. [\[2\]](#)

Cross-references — This is one of the most directly relevant notes for coo4one architecture because it argues against building another monolith. [\[2\]](#)

- **Source** — Modular software design - discussion with RaycastAI

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — Unix / App Intents / system architecture

Excerpt — Ven argues that Unix got three separations right: data storage/representation, data manipulation, and data presentation. He

contrasts this with modern app silos where note apps, task managers, e-book readers, and messengers store data in proprietary databases accessible only through the app's own interface. [\[3\]](#)[\[36\]](#)

Cross-references — This connects directly to the “Case for Modularity” and “We need more modular software” cards. [\[1\]](#)[\[2\]](#)

- **Source — Modular software design - discussion with RaycastAI**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — Apple EntityKit / permissions model

Excerpt — Ven argues that Apple already has a security blueprint through HealthKit and location services, with granular permissions, system-level trust, standardized permission dialogs, visibility, and revocability. He explores extending that model to a universal entity framework where read metadata, read content, write metadata, write content, delete, and share rights can be granted explicitly. [\[10\]](#)[\[11\]](#)

Cross-references — Journal 2025-05-16 shows Ven admiring Apple's direction with Shortcuts, deep links, APIs, and structured object/type-based information. [\[8\]](#)

- **Source — Modular software design - discussion with RaycastAI**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — global metadata / cross-app tags

Excerpt — Ven criticizes Apple's fragmented metadata: Finder/iCloud tags, Notes/Reminders tags, Mail, Calendar, Photos, Safari bookmarks, and Freeform do not share a consistent global tag model. He imagines a shared tagging/entity query system across Finder, Reminders, Notes, Email, Calendar, Photos, Safari bookmarks, and other apps, enabling dashboard tools to query and display project-relevant entities. [\[9\]](#)

Cross-references — The Zotero Tagging System notes show Ven's preference for controlled vocabularies, low-friction intake, and saved-search dashboards in a narrower academic-reading domain. [\[37\]](#)[\[38\]](#)[\[39\]](#)

- **Source — Modular software design - discussion with RaycastAI**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — Raycast / Alfred / neo-CLI

Excerpt — Ven frames Raycast and Alfred as modern command interfaces: visual, searchable, extension-based, entity-centric, and easier than a traditional CLI, but still limited by app APIs, lack of system-level integration, limited inter-tool communication, and app-specific data formats. [\[40\]](#)[\[41\]](#)
[\[22\]](#)

Cross-references — Heptabase limitations include no automations/API/Raycast integration, which makes this especially relevant to coo4one's desired integration layer.

- **Source — Modular software design - discussion with RaycastAI**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — Hookmark / entity relationships

Excerpt — Ven sees Hookmark as an underutilized prototype of an overlay app paradigm that links entities through deep links and may be a first step toward solving disarray caused by app-based models. He also notes that Hookmark's linked entities are unaware of their links, so it cannot yet provide full system-level modularity. [\[22\]](#)[\[42\]](#)[\[23\]](#)

Cross-references — The "Brainstorm uses for Hookmark" board asks whether Hookmark's network can be visualized, whether it can be used like a database, and whether the pinned bar could support projects.

Apple ecosystem appreciation / native-app expectations

- **Source — Journal 2025-05-16**

Date — 2025-05-16

Why-relevant tag — Apple Shortcuts / structured objects

Excerpt — Ven admires Apple's attempts with Shortcuts, universal deep links, APIs, and object/type-based models for organizing information such as dates, emails, contacts, reminders, and locations. He asks whether he can extract webpage Reader Mode text through Shortcuts and share it with Heptabase, or extract links from Zotero. [\[8\]](#)

Cross-references — The "Apple Shortcuts" card contains ideas for meeting-note creation, time tracking, and placing shortcuts on a Freeform board as a kind of custom UI. [\[43\]](#)

- **Source — Apple Shortcuts**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — automation surface / custom UI

Excerpt — Ven wants to find good uses for Shortcuts, including creating meeting notes and logging structured information to notes. He imagines putting Shortcuts on a Freeform board and having their results inserted, effectively creating a custom UI. [\[43\]](#)

Cross-references — This connects to Journal 2025-05-16's admiration for Shortcuts and deep-link-based automation. [\[8\]](#)

- Source** — I never knew how flexible Mac's OS file system was
Date — not visible
Why-relevant tag — native Mac affordances
Excerpt — Ven notes that the Mac file system is flexible through tags, smart search, and grouped view, and that these can generate useful saved-search-style views. [\[44\]](#)
Cross-references — This connects to the broader desire for global metadata and queryable entity dashboards across apps. [\[9\]](#)
- Source** — 10 Great Mac Bookmarking Apps and Services: How They Compare – Hookmark
Date — not visible
Why-relevant tag — native bookmarking / link management
Excerpt — Ven compares bookmarking tools, noting that Anybox has hierarchical tags, smart lists, a general sidebar, and native iOS support; GoodLinks has reading and highlighting options; and linking looks good but is self-hosted and does not work with iOS unless perhaps bridged by a REST API and Shortcuts. [\[45\]](#)
Cross-references — This pairs with the Hookmark brainstorming board and the broader need for cross-app links and entities. [\[22\]](#)
- Source** — Brainstorm uses for Hookmark
Date — not visible
Why-relevant tag — pleasant native navigation / project overlay
Excerpt — Ven notes that Hookmark navigation is “super pleasant,” asks whether the network can be visualized, whether it can be used like a database, and whether the pinned bar can be used for projects.
Cross-references — This is a concrete exploration of the same system-level linking concept discussed abstractly in “Modular software design.” [\[22\]](#)[\[42\]](#)

PKM philosophy / Heptabase workflows

- Source** — Learning Heptabase
Date — not visible
Why-relevant tag — spatial PKM value
Excerpt — Ven writes that spatial organization and the infinite canvas help him keep track of a large amount of information, avoid losing track of where he is or what he is doing, and understand how notes connect. [\[25\]](#)
Cross-references — This positive note should be balanced against the

earlier concern that infinite canvases can make it difficult to stay aware of what else is available on the board. [\[6\]](#)

- **Source — Making knowledge building enjoyable is key**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — enjoyable knowledge work / anti-friction

Excerpt — Ven says knowledge restructuring is how long-lasting knowledge is created, but he often avoids it after consuming media because it is boring or difficult. He says Heptabase can make the process feel like play, while apps like Roam or Capacities make him get lost and create the same notes multiple times. [\[46\]](#)

Cross-references — This reinforces the “mind-reader UI” principle: coo4one should make the right action feel natural rather than administrative. [\[19\]](#)

- **Source — Heptabase Fundamentals 101: Notes**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — atomic notes / source-to-synthesis workflow

Excerpt — Ven describes Heptabase’s goal as flexibly creating reusable atomic knowledge. His workflow is to take notes freely while reading, then structure later by extracting atomic notes from larger source notes, giving them good titles, connecting them to other notes, and revisiting existing whiteboards when researching a new topic or starting a project. [\[26\]](#)

Cross-references — This matches the Heptabase tutorial’s workflow of extracting atomic knowledge cards from sources, reusing cards across boards, and recombining old knowledge for new problems. [\[47\]](#)[\[48\]](#)[\[49\]](#)

- **Source — Separate the writing from the editing process**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — capture first, structure later

Excerpt — Ven compares note restructuring to writing: getting ideas out and editing them require different mindsets, and trying to do both at the same time lets the “Editor” block expression. [\[50\]](#)

Cross-references — This supports a coo4one capture model where messy capture is separated from later AI-assisted organization. [\[50\]](#)[\[51\]](#)

- **Source — Quick capture**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — capture requirement

Excerpt — Ven says whatever app he uses for random thoughts, questions, or tasks throughout the day needs a really easy quick-capture option. [\[51\]](#)

Cross-references — The file/note management whiteboard lists “no quick capture” as a limitation.

- **Source — Building a Second Brain**

Date — originally created May 7, 2023 in Notion

Why-relevant tag — PKM philosophy / trusted place

Excerpt — Ven’s notes emphasize capturing only noteworthy ideas and insights in a trusted place he controls, organizing notes according to active projects, distilling notes to their essence, and using reviews to keep notes useful. [\[52\]](#)[\[53\]](#)[\[54\]](#)

Cross-references — The “Capture only what is worthwhile” card isolates this trusted-place principle into a separate note on the restructuring board. [\[55\]](#)

- **Source — Capture only what is worthwhile in a trusted place you control**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — capture filter / trusted place

Excerpt — The note says content piles up everywhere, capture is often haphazard, and insights can remain hidden in forgotten folders or the cloud. The proposed solution is to capture only what resonates in a trusted place you control. [\[55\]](#)

Cross-references — This complements the app-detox notes about scattered information and decision fatigue. [\[5\]](#)[\[24\]](#)

Academic reading / Zotero / PDF workflow

- **Source — Journal 2025-03-13**

Date — 2025-03-13

Why-relevant tag — dream academic reading system

Excerpt — Ven wants a unified automated system for collecting, reading, tracking, annotating, and linking scientific articles, books, videos, blogs, and other content. His ideal example: while reading a paper, click a cited reference and have the referenced paper automatically added with metadata, full text, links to the current paper and related references, and tags or reading-list status. [\[13\]](#)

Cross-references — This is the strongest research-specific version of coo4one’s broader entity-linking dream. [\[13\]](#)[\[20\]](#)

- **Source — My problem with tracking academic readings**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — reading inbox failure

Excerpt — Ven saves interesting academic articles either to a Zotero Inbox collection or to Things, but rarely reads them later. Zotero's inbox accumulates papers, he lacks a habit of processing it, and saving papers outpaces reading them. [\[14\]](#)

Cross-references — He considers integrating Things so a deep link to a Zotero item is automatically added as a task to a specific list. [\[56\]](#)

- **Source — Rethinking my PDF research workflow**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — Zotero/PDF workflow needs

Excerpt — Ven likes Zotero's automatic metadata extraction, single-click web capture with full-text PDF and metadata, collections/tags, and effortless cross-device sync. He dislikes that Zotero lacks Wikipedia-style reference following, AI interaction with PDFs, and note organization. [\[15\]](#)

Cross-references — This connects to the dream of automatically adding and linking referenced papers from within an article. [\[13\]](#)

- **Source — Zotero integration: Potential friction points**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — Zotero integration requirements

Excerpt — Ven notes possible duplication between Zotero and Heptabase around PDF storage and annotations, because Zotero already handles PDF highlighting and tablet/stylus annotation well. He also says if drafting in Heptabase, it would need citation and bibliography insertion, and Zotero-reference objects/tags could support an insert-citation function. [\[16\]](#)

Cross-references — This sets concrete requirements for academic-writing integration: citation insertion, bibliography generation, object-level references, and avoiding duplicate annotation silos. [\[16\]](#)

- **Source — Notes about initial Zotero integration experience**

Date — 2026-02-23 mentioned inside note

Why-relevant tag — Heptabase-Zotero integration friction

Excerpt — Ven reports that syncing Zotero to Heptabase was slow or stuck during testing, but he liked that PDFs get parsed like PDFs uploaded in Heptabase and can be chatted with. He also notes that manual sync is annoying, and that first-version limitations around mobile source cards, dragging source cards to whiteboards, backlinks, and chat would be important. [\[57\]](#)[\[58\]](#)[\[59\]](#)

Cross-references — This is a concrete example of integration value plus friction for coo4one to avoid. [\[57\]](#)[\[59\]](#)

- **Source — Zotero Tagging System — Reference Note**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — low-friction research metadata

Excerpt — Ven's Zotero tagging system is built around low-friction intake, binary judgments, search and saved searches for fine detail, and tags that encode role, topic, method, workflow status, and qualitative affordances.

[\[37\]](#)[\[38\]](#)

Cross-references — The system includes temporary workflow tags such as unread, shortlist, skimmed, read, annotated, cite, and revisit, plus a maintenance rule to prevent tag drift. [\[60\]](#)[\[61\]](#)

- **Source — Saved-search dashboards**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — dashboard retrieval / queues

Excerpt — Ven's design pushes fine detail into search and saved searches instead of exploding the tag set, making saved-search dashboards the main way to retrieve workflows quickly. Example dashboards include a weekly reading queue, a cite-soon pipeline, teaching prep, open materials to reuse, method learning sprints, and "about vs used" contrast searches.

[\[39\]](#)

Cross-references — This is directly relevant to coo4one dashboards and personal assistant "views" generated from structured metadata. [\[39\]](#)[\[9\]](#)

Workflow routines / reviews / inboxes

- **Source — Building a Second Brain**

Date — originally created May 7, 2023 in Notion

Why-relevant tag — weekly/monthly review pattern

Excerpt — Ven's notes include project kickoff and completion checklists, weekly review steps such as clearing email inbox, checking calendar, clearing desktop, clearing notes inbox, and choosing tasks for the week, plus monthly reviews of goals, projects, responsibilities, someday/maybe tasks, and priorities. [\[54\]](#)[\[62\]](#)

Cross-references — The highlight "Clear my email inbox. Check my calendar. Clear my computer desktop. Clear my notes inbox. Choose my tasks for the week." isolates this as a compact review routine. [\[63\]](#)

- **Source — Develop trustworthy inbox systems and review practices**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — inbox/review principle

Excerpt — The note title itself captures a high-level goal: Ven wants trustworthy inbox systems and review practices. [\[64\]](#)

Cross-references — This is placed on the “Restructure file and note management” whiteboard alongside capture sources such as email, web links, YouTube videos, books, online resources, academic articles, and online articles.

- **Source** — By embedding links to whiteboards in my daily note, I can see what I have worked on over time

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — activity history / project memory

Excerpt — The title states a concrete practice: embedding links to whiteboards in the daily note allows Ven to see what he has worked on over time. [\[17\]](#)

Cross-references — This connects to daily summaries and AI activity overviews. [\[12\]](#)[\[4\]](#)

Long-tail but relevant sources

- **Source** — Current Apps

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — current tool stack

Excerpt — Ven’s current stack includes Things for tasks, Heptabase and Capacities for note-taking, Spark and Outlook for email, Google and Apple for calendar, and Raindrop for links; he says he needs to rethink and simplify. [\[7\]](#)

- **Source** — Location of notes and note backups

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — migration/consolidation map

Excerpt — Ven lists note sources he has reviewed or exported, including Heptabase, Bear, Apple Notes, Capacities, Notion, Obsidian, Notability, and Nebo. [\[65\]](#)

- **Source** — What I like and dislike about different apps

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — app comparison seed

Excerpt — Ven begins a comparison of apps and notes that he likes Capacities’ object types, though the note is incomplete. [\[66\]](#)

- **Source — Crucial apps for my workflow**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — app/knowledge map idea

Excerpt — Ven considers building something like a visual map for his apps and knowledge, possibly also using the idea for spaced repetition. [\[67\]](#)

- **Source — With Hookmark, simply use the “Hook to New” command...**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — cross-app note creation

Excerpt — Ven notes Hookmark’s “Hook to New” command for taking notes in the app of choice and records the shortcut sequence. [\[68\]](#)

- **Source — AppleScript to send keystroke to app**

Date — not visible

Why-relevant tag — automation workaround

Excerpt — Ven has an AppleScript that activates Heptabase and sends keyboard input, showing willingness to automate apps even when direct APIs are absent. [\[69\]](#)